Children and Adults Monitor Speaker Ignorance to Learn Words Cross-Situationally

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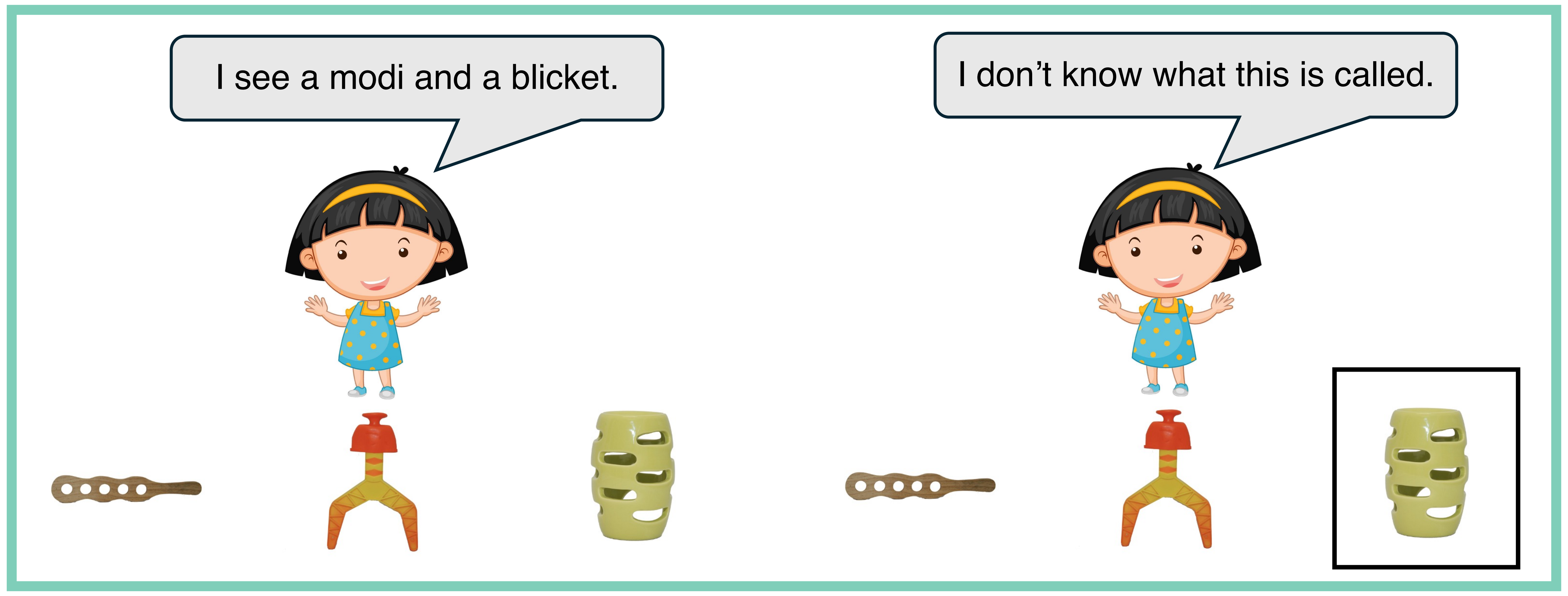
Background

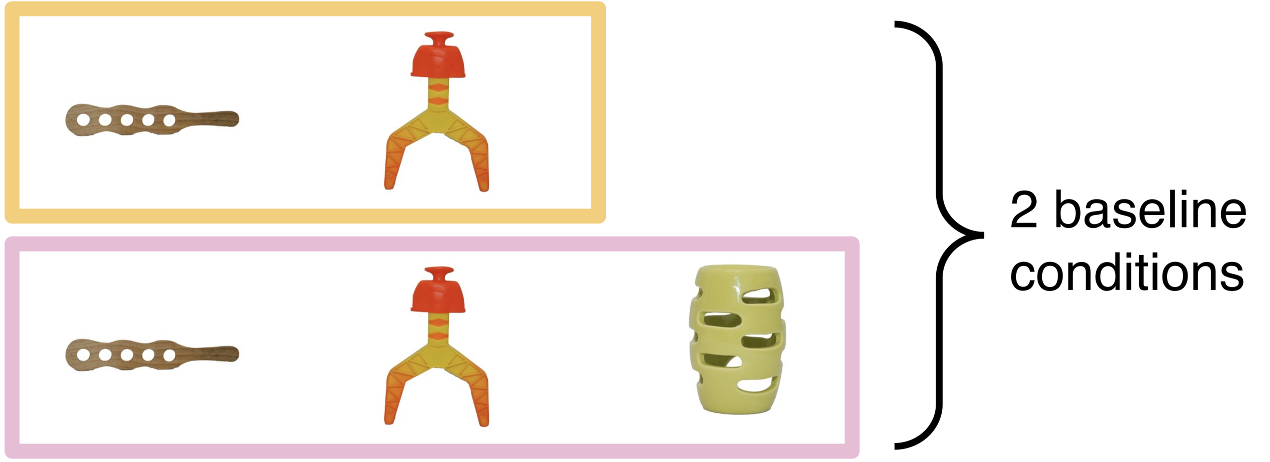
- Children encounter words in many ambiguous contexts.
- Tracking co-occurrences between words and referents across learning contexts allows children to learn novel words.[1,2]
- Children also monitor speakers' intentions and knowledge to aid word learning.[3,4,5]

Research Question

Do children **consider speakers' knowledge** when **learning words cross-situationally**?

Methods





- **Speaker-ignorant objects** co-occur erroneously **more often** than other distractors.
- Participants learn **8 novel words** in **20 learning trials**.
- **16 test trials**: 3-AFC: target – speaker-ignorant – other
- Children received Theory of Mind battery (not predictive of performance.)

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